

Configuring VPC Flow Logs in AWS

To begin with the Lab

Summary of the Lab

This lab demonstrates how to configure AWS VPC Flow Logs and store them in an Amazon S3 bucket. First, create an S3 bucket and copy its ARN from the bucket properties. Then, in the VPC console, create a Flow Log for the desired VPC, choose to capture accepted traffic, set the maximum aggregation interval to 10 minutes, and select Amazon S3 as the destination using the copied ARN. Configure the log format as Plain Text, activate the Flow Log, and verify that log files are delivered to the S3 bucket.

- Note: This lab assume a running ec2 instance and a vpc that is connected to ec2.
- Create an Amazon S3 Bucket
- Navigate to the Amazon S3 service.
- Click Create Bucket and provide a unique bucket name
- Leave the remaining settings as default and create the bucket.

The screenshot shows the 'Create bucket' page in the AWS S3 console. The breadcrumb navigation at the top reads 'Amazon S3 > Buckets > Create bucket'. The page title is 'Create bucket' with an 'Info' link. Below the title, it states 'Buckets are containers for data stored in S3.' The 'General configuration' section is active. Under 'AWS Region', 'US East (N. Virginia) us-east-1' is selected. Under 'Bucket type', 'General purpose' is selected with a blue circle, and 'Directory' is unselected. The 'General purpose' option has a tooltip that says 'Recommended for most use cases and access patterns. General purpose buckets are the original S3 bucket type. They allow a mix of storage classes that redundantly store objects across multiple Availability Zones.' Under 'Bucket namespace', 'Global namespace' is selected with a blue circle, and 'Account Regional namespace (recommended)' is unselected. The 'Global namespace' option has a tooltip that says 'By default, S3 creates general purpose buckets in the global namespace.' Under 'Bucket name', the text 'cf-bucket01-flow-logs' is entered in the input field. Below the input field, a note states 'Bucket names must be 3 to 63 characters and unique within the global namespace. Bucket names must also begin and end with a letter or number. Valid characters are a-z, 0-9, periods (.), and hyphens (-). Learn more'. At the bottom, there is a 'Copy settings from existing bucket - optional' section with a 'Choose bucket' button. A small text at the very bottom reads 'Format: cf-bucket01-flow-logs'.

- Open the newly created S3 Bucket.
- Navigate to the **Properties** tab.
- Locate and copy the **Amazon Resource Name (ARN)** of the bucket.
- This ARN will be required while configuring the VPC Flow Log destination.

The screenshot shows the 'Properties' tab of the 'cf-bucket01-flow-logs' bucket in the AWS S3 console. The breadcrumb navigation at the top reads 'cf-bucket01-flow-logs' with an 'Info' link. Below the breadcrumb, there are tabs for 'Objects', 'Metadata', 'Properties' (which is active), 'Permissions', 'Metrics', 'Management', 'File systems - new', and 'Access Points'. The 'Bucket overview' section is visible. It contains three items: 'AWS Region' with the value 'US East (N. Virginia) us-east-1', 'Amazon Resource Name (ARN)' with the value 'arn:aws:s3:::cf-bucket01-flow-logs' (which is highlighted with a green box and a 'Bucket ARN copied' tooltip), and 'Creation date' with the value 'July 6, 2026, 14:48:27 (UTC+05:30)'.

- Return to the **VPC** service.
- Select the VPC for which you want to capture network traffic.

- Click **Actions** → **Create Flow Log**.
- Provide a meaningful name for the Flow Log.
- elect the type of traffic that should be logged.
- Choose one of the following options depending on your monitoring requirements:
Accepted Traffic

☰ [VPC](#) > [Your VPCs](#) > Create flow logs 🔍 ⚙️ 📄

Create flow log info

Flow logs can capture IP traffic flow information for the network interfaces associated with your resources. You can create multiple flow logs to send traffic to different destinations.

Selected resources info

Flow logs will only be created for resources in an available state.

Name	Resource ID	State
	vpc-099792461c7d0a616	Available

Flow log settings

Name - optional

Filter

The type of traffic to capture (accepted traffic only, rejected traffic only, or all traffic).

☒ Accept
☐ Reject
☐ All

- Configure the **Maximum Aggregation Interval**.
- Select **10 Minutes** so that AWS aggregates network traffic for up to ten minutes before delivering the log records.

Maximum aggregation interval info

The maximum interval of time during which a flow of packets is captured and aggregated into a flow log record.

☒ 10 minutes
☐ 1 minute

Destination

The destination to which to publish the flow log data.

☐ Send to CloudWatch Logs
☒ Send to an Amazon S3 bucket
☐ Send to Amazon Data Firehose in the same account
☐ Send to Amazon Data Firehose in a different account

S3 bucket ARN

The ARN of the Amazon S3 bucket to which the flow log is published. You can specify a specific folder in the bucket using the `arn:aws:s3:::[bucket-name]/[folder_name]/` format.

Must be in the format: `arn:aws:s3:::[bucket-name]`

[Create S3 bucket](#)

🔔 Please note, a resource-based policy will be created for you and attached to the target bucket.

- Choose the **Destination** for storing the logs.
- Select **Send to Amazon S3**.
- Paste the **S3 Bucket ARN** copied in the previous step.

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[Create S3 bucket](#)

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- Choose the **Log File Format**.
- Select **Plain Text** so that the generated Flow Logs are easy to read and analyze.

Log record format

Specify the fields to include in the flow log record.

- ☒ AWS default format
☐ Custom format

Additional metadata

Include additional metadata to AWS default log record format.

- ☐ Include Amazon ECS metadata

EC2 tag fields

Include EC2 tag information in flow log records.

- ☐ Include EC2 tag field specifications

Format preview

```
${version} ${account-id} ${interface-id} ${srcaddr} ${dstaddr} ${srcport} ${dstport} ${protocol} ${packets} ${bytes} ${start} ${end} ${action} ${log-status}
```

Copy

Log file format

[Info](#)

The format for the log files. Each log file is compressed using Gzip compression.

- ☒ Text (default)
☐ Parquet

- Wait until the Flow Log status changes to **Active**.
- The VPC is now configured to capture network traffic.
- You can navigate to the S3 bucket

Amazon S3 > Buckets > cf-bucket01-flow-logs > AWSLogs/ > 463646775279/ > vpcflowlogs/ > us-east-1/ > 2026/ > 07/ > 06/

Objects (23)

Objects are the fundamental entities stored in Amazon S3. You can use [Amazon S3 inventory](#) to get a list of all objects in your bucket. For others to access your objects, you'll need to explicitly grant them permissions. [Learn more](#)

Find objects by prefix

☐	Name	Type	Last modified	Size	Storage class
☐	463646775279_vpcflowlogs_us-east-1_fl-0ed14fdc918235ad_20260706T0950Z_d21ad3b6.log.gz	gz	July 6, 2026, 15:25:35 (UTC+05:30)	600.0 B	Standard
☐	463646775279_vpcflowlogs_us-east-1_fl-0ed14fdc918235ad_20260706T0950Z_f298b12b.log.gz	gz	July 6, 2026, 15:30:35 (UTC+05:30)	164.0 B	Standard
☐	463646775279_vpcflowlogs_us-east-1_fl-0ed14fdc918235ad_20260706T0955Z_1ab5df9e.log.gz	gz	July 6, 2026, 15:35:36 (UTC+05:30)	185.0 B	Standard